

FIELD GUIDE

Snack's List

The resources, programs, and people worth knowing for the military-to-civilian transition.

Curated by Jack Kruse

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A living list — links and notes updated as the landscape changes.

Start here.

READ THIS FIRST

Before you click a single link, read one book: [The 20-Minute Networking Meeting](#) by Perez & Ballinger (there's also a [Veteran Edition](#)). You can read it in an hour, and you shouldn't take a single networking meeting or call until you have. The authors hand you a script and a plan to maximize every 20-minute coffee or call. Quite simply — it just works.

01 Strategy, Planning & Tracking

Veteran Timeline

A comprehensive, customizable roadmap tracking medical, administrative, and career milestones.

| **Snack's take** — At a minimum, look at this two years out just to scare yourself with how much there is to do.

Prize Inc.

A mobile app offering a personalized transition roadmap and a curated database of verified support resources.

Debriefed

An open-source transition repository designed to help you methodically reflect and plan your post-military journey.

BaseNeed

Delivers essential, centralized transition, networking, and logistical support for military families.

02 Mentorship & Networking

FourBlock

A nationwide career-readiness program helping veterans build professional networks in major corporate hubs.

VetsinTech

A nonprofit connecting veterans and military spouses to tech careers through education, mentorship, hiring events, and local chapters nationwide.

| **Recommended by** — former Navy FAO [Mark Bruno](#), Founder and CEO of [Arbor Global Advisory](#)

American Corporate Partners (ACP)

Connects transitioning service members directly with Fortune 500 executives for a year of dedicated mentorship.

Snack's take — Love this program. They also have a military-spouse program (see Family & Spouses).

Sitreps to Steercos

Unfiltered, highly tactical career advice focused on MBA insights and corporate strategy realities.

Snack's take — Stay for the comic takedowns of people shilling bogus courses on LinkedIn.

The COMMIT Foundation

High-touch, personalized executive coaching with a strong emphasis on values clarification and identity.

MilMentor

A "post-Veterati" platform offering on-demand networking and mentorship calls with professionals at top companies.

CareerNerds

Executive career coaching focused heavily on LinkedIn optimization and the hidden executive job market.

MMG Leaders

A vetted network connecting transitioning senior military leaders with elite corporate executives and mentors.

Veterans Coaching Project (VCP)

An intensive, immersive program providing executive coaching and workforce training at no cost.

SeniorMilitaryTransition.com

Coaching specifically for retiring senior leaders, to help translate command-level experience.

03 Resumes, Translation & Interview Prep

BestMilitaryResume.com

An AI platform trained on federal data that translates your evaluations into competitive corporate/federal resumes.

Snack's take — Upload your fitreps and evals and it parses them into a civilian resume. Best of all, the creator is engaged and active throughout the process.

Hire Heroes USA

Highly tactical, hands-on support for resume metric alignment, interview prep, and direct job placement.

Snack's take — Great and engaged team.

Purepost Inc.

Cloud-based software that instantly translates military experience into civilian business skills.

Still Serving Veterans

Free, personalized career counseling, interview prep, and veteran-to-veteran resume development.

Warriors to Work (WWP)

Career counseling, resume writing, and employer networking tailored for wounded warriors.

Operation New Uniform

Focuses on the soft skills of transition and coaching to build your professional civilian brand.

04 Upskilling, Certifications & Education

ACT NOW Education

Free virtual, instructor-led training to secure civilian credentials like PMP and Scrum Master.

Onward to Opportunity

Partners with Syracuse University for free, high-demand industry certifications and career training.

Code Platoon

Immersive software-engineering bootcamps designed to transition veterans into tech careers.

Microsoft Software and Systems Academy (MSSA)

A full-time, 17-week, Microsoft-funded program training transitioning service members for cloud, cybersecurity, and IT careers, with access to 1,100+ hiring partners. A military-spouse version is listed under Family & Spouses.

Recommended by — former Navy FAO [Mark Bruno](#), Founder and CEO of [Arbor Global Advisory](#)

Student Veterans of America (SVA)

The premier network supporting veterans in higher education.

05 Fellowships, Events & Direct Placement

Hiring Our Heroes (HOH)

DoD SkillBridge corporate fellowships, large hiring events, and spouse employment pipelines.

Military Onboard Solutions

Helps civilian organizations become SkillBridge-approved and design customized fellowships.

VetJobs

A leading employment hub connecting transitioning military personnel with civilian employers.

Redeployment

Workforce integration that maps and redeploys veteran talent into high-demand civilian sectors.

7 Eagle Group

Connects veterans with employers for permanent leadership, technical, and contract-to-hire roles.

NextOp

Places mid-grade enlisted leaders into careers in energy, manufacturing, and construction.

Corporate Gray

Military-focused job fairs and transition workshops linking personnel with corporate recruiters.

Project RELO

Immersive, multi-day leadership events bringing corporate executives and veterans together.

Service Academy Career Conference (SACC)

The only career conference exclusively connecting Service Academy graduates with industry leaders.

Stand-To Veteran Leadership Program

A selective George W. Bush Institute initiative that empowers veteran leaders and builds elite networks.

| **Snack's take** — This one is sundowning — check out Presidential Leadership Scholars (next) instead.

Presidential Leadership Scholars

Not veteran-specific: gathers mid-career professionals to hone leadership through former presidents, senior officials, academics, and civic leaders.

| **Snack's take** — I can't think of a better outcomes-based networking opportunity if you're accepted.

06 Headhunters & Executive Search

TheMilVet

A retained executive-search firm dedicated to placing elite veteran leaders into C-suite and VP roles.

Korn Ferry (Military Transition)

A premier global executive-search firm placing veterans into top-tier corporate leadership.

DRiWaterstone Human Capital

Executive search specializing in the non-profit and social-enterprise sectors.

Bradley-Morris

One of the largest military recruiting firms, matching officers with top business-sector roles.

Cameron-Brooks

Focused entirely on translating Junior Military Officer leadership into corporate business careers.

Booz Allen Hamilton (Military Talent)

A structured military talent community placing veterans into defense-sector and consulting roles.

07 Benefits, Finance & Logistics

The Better Veteran Toolbox & C&P Prep

Free tools to calculate optimal benefits, plus AI guidance to document conditions for VA C&P exams.

Snack's take — This site is pretty amazing.

MilCalc

A free, offline-capable calculator to project your military pension, VA disability, and state taxes.

VA VR&E

Employment assistance, education funding, and vocational rehabilitation pathways.

Texas Military Department — Transition & Employment

Local advisors for Texas state benefits and employment for transitioning personnel.

Veterans Transition Support (VTS)

Hands-on, practical transition training for active-duty personnel.

08 Family & Spouses

Blue Star Families

Advocacy, family support networks, and scholarship resources.

Military OneSource

A centralized hub for transition assistance, spouse employment, moving logistics, and financial counseling.

Military Spouse Employment Partnership (MSEP)

Connects military spouses with hundreds of partner employers.

USO Transition Program

Connects service members and families to local employment and mentorship through regional hubs.

MOAA Foundation Career Transition

Career counseling, virtual career fairs, and networking forums for transitioning officers' families.

FourBlock Military Spouse Readiness Program

Helps military spouses build confidence and pursue careers aligned with their strengths and goals.

MSSA–Military Spouse

A 17-week Microsoft training pilot preparing military spouses for portable, remote-friendly technical program management roles in IT.

| **Recommended by** — former Navy FAO [Mark Bruno](#), Founder and CEO of [Arbor Global Advisory](#)

09 Entrepreneurship

SBA Boots to Business

Foundational entrepreneurship training and resources to start a small business.

Bunker Labs

Community-driven entrepreneurship support, networking, and incubators for veteran founders.